

One of the major changes in the way that social media management is being applied in the past few years has been to moderate and modify social media profiles and the information shared on these profiles to provide the best possible optimisation for search engine queries. The way to optimise searches through a social media account is not just a simple matter of increasing the traffic on your profile through a greater number of followers on Twitter or Facebook. In 2013, much to the shock of social media experts, Google's Matt Cutts announced through a video that Google search rankings are not influenced by metrics on social media such as Facebook likes or Twitter followers. This is despite the fact that market experts, until that point, were told by both Google and Bing that Twitter fandom directly affects search results. Over the years, it has been discovered that while links definitely do exist between social media and search engine optimisation, these links operate in far more subtle manners than previously thought. There are many differences between the way pages and profiles are ranked on Google and Bing search results. In this article, we analyse some of the ways in which social media profiles and pages affect search results.

## Tailoring social media content for SEO

The first thing to understand that search engines use many different metrics to vary how search results are shown and the algorithms that determine search results combine information collected from all of these metrics. This makes the task of pinpointing any one characteristic that can guarantee optimisation at the highest level an impossible one. This is also why the question of the amount of importance given by search engines to social media popularity has many disputed answers. The equation is further complicated by dynamical relationships between search engines and social media platforms. Facebook, for example, allows Google to index its content in a relationship that benefits both parties involved: better search results for Google and more traffic for Facebook. This is why mobile searches often lead you directly to the Facebook app when you search for a person and find a Facebook link. The indexing extends to status updates and posts on timelines as well, allowing search engine users to search for extremely detailed queries. Search engine optimisation therefore is no longer just a popularity contest, it's also about tailoring content on social media to optimise search results.

It is possible for individuals to drive traffic to pages based on content through posts on social media accounts which have a higher following